

Commonly Misunderstood and Misapplied Little League Rules - PA D27 2026 Edition

Rule	Topic	BB	8-10	9-11	LL (10-12)	Intermed (11-13)	Junior (12-14)	Senior (13-16)
	SB	8-10	9-11	LL (10-12)		Junior (12-14)		Senior (13-16)
3.09 Reg XIV(f)	Warming Up Pitchers	Reagular Season Games: Managers/Coaches MAY warm-up Pitchers. One minute between innings applies. TOURNAMENT GAMES: NO ADULTS MAY WARM UP PITCHERS						
1.12 1.17	Catcher Requirements	ALL CATCHERS MUST WEAR DANGLING THROAT GUARD - NO EXCEPTIONS MUST wear helmet/mask/dangler combo when warming up pitchers AND catching infield/outfield practice Baseball: Must use Catcher's Mitt SOFTBALL: Catcher's Mitt NOT required						
1.10 note 1	Batting Donuts	NO Batting Donuts. Bat Sleeves are OK						
1.11 (k)	Casts	NO Players, Coaches, Managers or Umpires with CASTS on field during game. May have cast in dugout.						
1.08	On Deck Batters	NO ON-DECK Batter. Only Lead-Off Hitter outside dugout between innings				Allowed outside Team's, NOT opponent's, dugout		
1.16	Batting Helmets	Helmets Non-Glare Surface. NO Mirror Finish. LL DOES NOT require Facemasks or Chin Straps. No Painted Helmets without written permission by helmet manufacturer.						
1.01, T Rule #4	Adults	MAX THREE Adults (Includes Manager, Coaches, Scorekeepers). MUST be approved Adult on roster and/or affidavit. INCLUDES Pre-game warm-ups and during games.						
4.04	Continuous Batting Order	All Players in batting order. Players arriving late, if put into game, placed at end of batting order. If a player leaves/cannot continue, spot in order is skipped (NOT AN OUT) If player injured & cannot continue, place next batter in order to bat or last batter out on base for injured base runner. No Special Pinch Runner if CBO is used.						
7.14	Special Runners	With 2 OUTS : Courtesy Runner for Pitcher and/or Catcher of record. Curtesy Runner is Player that made LAST OUT . NO Special Pinch Runner with Continuous Batting Order						Special Pinch Runner Rules Apply
Reg IV	Mandatory Play	Regular Season: Six Defensive outs & One At-Bat. Tournament Games: NO Defensive Out requirement						Tournament: NO Mandatory Play
1.15, 1.10	Pitchers (BB)	Batting Glove under Pitcher's Glove is OK ; NOT white, grey or optic yellow; Pitcher's glove NOT white or grey. Sunglasses are OK . Pitcher's undershirt sleeves, if exposed, NOT white or gray. Neoprene sleeves on pitcher must be solid color, not white or gray. NO sweatbands on either arm. Umpire sole judge if items on pitcher are distracting.						
1.15C, 8.02(a)(2)	Pitchers (SB)	Pitchers Glove CANNOT be nor have ball color of ball. Items may be worn on a pitcher's glove arm (non-pitching arm) so long as a solid, single color: black, white, gray, or uniform color. Pitch/play calling band on <u>ARM ONLY</u> , not belt and cannot be white, grey or optic yellow.						
6.05	Throwing the Bat	Throwing the bat (unless intentional) is NEVER AN OUT . Warn player for first offense (not at pre-game conference), then removal for later offenses <u>may</u> warrented. Warnings are per player, NOT a team warning						
7.08(a).3	Must Slide	There is <u>NO MUST SLIDE RULE</u> at ANY Base						
7.08(6)	Overrunning First Base	First base MAY be overrun on a walk. Batter-runner may turn LEFT or RIGHT after overrunning first base. Only if Batter-runner makes an attempt toward 2nd base has he/she lost overun protection.						
7.08(a).4	Head First Slide	Head First Slides NOT ALLOWED (automatic out) when advancing. Head First Slide IS NOT a trip, stumble, crawl to base, hands touch before feet.				Head First Slides Permitted		
6.08(b)	Pitch Hits Batter	NO rule for number of Batters a Pitcher may hit with pitches to force removal as a pitcher.						
2.0 BALL, STRIKE	Pitches on Ground	Pitches that hit ground ARE NOT dead balls. Batter may swing, hit, foul off, etc. Batter hit by bouncing pitch MAY BE awarded first base (unless batter was swinging).						
6.05(b) 6.09(b)	Uncaught Third Strike	Batter Out	Swinging or Called Strike 3. Less than 2 OUT - Batter OUT IF 1st base is occupied at time of pitch. First Base Ununoccupied OR two outs, batter becomes runner and defense must put out.					
2.0 FAIR Territory	Home Plate	Home Plate is FAIR territory. Balls hitting Home Plate ARE NOT Dead.Batter stepping on plate IS NOT automatically out.						
6.06 (c) (1)	Batters Box	Batter's Box IS NOT a safety zone for batter. Batter must attempt to vacate batter's box to avoid interference with a play. Batter MAY be called out for failure to avoid interference.						
6.02 (c)	Batter/Batter's Box	After entering batter's box, batter must remain in batters box with at least one foot throughout at bat (with exceptions) Penalty: Warn batter, then automatic strike.						
2.0 BUNT	Bunt/Fake Bunt	FAKE BUNT then Swing at Pitch is LEGAL in LLBB/SB						
2.0 BUNT	Bunting	Batter does not pull bat out of strike zone while in bunting position BASEBALL: NOT Automatic Strike SOFTBALL: AUTOMATIC Strike						
2.0 Infield Fly	Infield Fly	Infield Fly Rule applies to ALL LL Baseball & Softball Tournaments						
6.08(a)(2)	Automatic Walks	BB & SB: Automatic Intentional Walk ALLOWED at any time. BB: ADD remaining pitches to Pitch Count. ONLY ONE Automatic Walk per player per game. Walking by throwing pitches is permitted.						
1.10	Bats - Baseball	Non-Wood - USABat Certification Required Wood Bat OK with proper dimensions/weight.				Non-Wood - USABat Certification or BBCOR		BBCOR ONLY
1.10	Bats - Softball	Non-wood Bats must be BPF = 1.20. Must be a Softball Bat. Wood bats OK. Cannot use Baseball Bat						
2.0, 6.08b	Bats - Hands	Hands are NEVER part of Bat						
7.10	Appeals	Live Ball/In Play Appeals ONLY . NO Dead Ball Appeals						
4.19	Protests	Playing Rule or Improper Substitution: BEFORE Next Play or Pitch Ineligible Pitcher or Mandatory Play: BEFORE Umpires leave field Ineligible Player: When facts become known, BEFORE next game						

Direct rules questions to Gary Hall, PA D27 UIC email: UMPIRED27@comcast.net

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Chart Information is intended as reference only and NOT a substitute for reading and understanding Little League Playing Rules.